

The Chronicle Spotlight: jucu

By Jadelyn Bautista *Insert Date Published*

Looking for a song to daydream about your self-directed film about youthful love and *yearning*?—jucu’s new single “Makahiya” might help you squeeze those creative juices out.

-photo of artist-

Photo courtesy of jucu

Embracing the black-and-white aesthetics of the song, 19-year-old Justine Curt Cardinal from North Caloocan shares about a “specific moment” behind his latest release—something that feels universally familiar to those who find composing romantic feelings for someone challenging.

“He’s a yearner from 2024, he’s waiting for the right moment to confess and to be with his wanna be future partner. The song interprets how the person does not have the courage to confess, and how he will wait no matter how long it is because he knows that it’ll be worth it in the future.” - jucu

Written by jucu (along with Arabela Grace Bugarin) and produced by Yuval Aguaviva, “Makahiya” feels like a deep midnight thought session where you debate with yourself whether telling your crush what you truly feel is a worthwhile choice. Like the *makahiya* plant, the feeling of bashfulness around someone you admire is highly evident in the song accompanied by uniquely-sounding percussions with tempo similar to the human heartbeat.

-photo of artist-

Photo courtesy of jucu

If jucu’s song would speak to its listeners, he believes that it would encourage people to embrace the bashfulness and “go with the flow”.

“Get to know each other as well. No need to rush.”

“Makahiya” is one among modern OPM releases that immerses in the realistic experiences and feelings behind someone’s shyness; which reminds us that loving someone means being imperfect—and that’s very admirable.

“Makahiya” is out now on major streaming platforms.